



**AFRICA
AGAINST CANCER**

UNITED. INFORMED. EMPOWERED.
TOGETHER WE CAN

VOLUNTEER & COMMUNITY IMPACT HANDBOOK

Building a Generation of
African Cancer Advocates



EDUCATE



SERVE



ADVOCATE



LEAD



IMPACT

LEARN. • SERVE. • LEAD. • IMPACT.

AFRICA AGAINST CANCER

AAC VOLUNTEER HANDBOOK

Learn • Serve • Lead • Impact

A practical guide to community service, cancer advocacy, skills contribution and recognition.

SIX-MONTH VOLUNTEER CYCLE

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SECTION 1: WELCOME TO AFRICA AGAINST CANCER

1.1 Welcome to Africa Against Cancer

Dear AAC Volunteer,

Welcome to Africa Against Cancer.

You are joining a community of young people, healthcare professionals, students, professionals, advocates, creatives and community leaders who believe that cancer prevention and education should not be limited to hospitals and specialists.

You do not need to be a doctor, pharmacist, nurse or scientist to contribute. You can contribute by educating people, organizing communities, creating content, designing materials, supporting projects, collecting information, creating awareness or using your professional skills to help AAC reach more people.

OUR GOAL

We want to turn volunteers into people who can create measurable change in their communities.

You will not simply receive a membership certificate because you joined AAC. You will have the opportunity to build a portfolio through real community service. Every project you participate in can become evidence of what you have done.

1.2 Who We Are

Africa Against Cancer is a cancer-focused organization working to improve cancer awareness, prevention, early detection, education, patient support, research and innovation across Africa.

- Educated communities
- Cancer advocates
- Healthcare professionals
- Students
- Researchers
- Teachers
- Digital creators
- Community leaders
- Policymakers
- Entrepreneurs
- Volunteers

1.3 Our Mission

Our mission is to mobilize and equip Africans to contribute to cancer prevention, early detection, education, patient support, research and innovation.

1.4 Who Can Participate

- University students
- Secondary school graduates
- Recent graduates
- Healthcare professionals
- Healthcare students
- Non-healthcare professionals
- Community leaders
- Teachers
- Researchers
- Designers
- Writers
- Photographers
- Videographers

- Social media managers
- Programmers
- Data analysts
- Business professionals
- Other people willing to contribute their skills

You do not need a medical background to participate. Non-healthcare volunteers will receive simple explanations of the cancer topics they need to understand before participating in community education. AAC will also provide the necessary educational materials and guidance.

1.5 What AAC Provides Volunteers

- Simple, approved cancer education materials
- Project guidance and coordination
- Opportunities to join community projects
- A structure for documenting your contribution
- Recognition and certificates based on completed contributions
- A community of volunteers, professionals and leaders
- Opportunities to grow into further AAC programmes and leadership roles

SECTION 2: UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROLE

2.1 What It Means to Be an AAC Volunteer

Being an AAC volunteer means that you are willing to contribute your time, skills or knowledge toward cancer-related community activities. You are not expected to do everything. You simply need to find the area where you can contribute best.

Volunteer	Possible Contribution
Pharmacy/health student	Educate students about cancer prevention
Business student	Organize a community project
Designer	Create cancer awareness materials
Videographer	Document AAC activities
Programmer	Help develop digital tools
Healthcare professional	Support technical education
Student team	Form a team and organize a school outreach

2.2 Volunteer Categories

2.3 Students

Students are strongly encouraged to use their school networks and form project teams. They can work together to reach secondary school students and divide education, coordination, assessment and documentation responsibilities.

2.4 Non-Students and Community Members

Non-students can participate in AAC projects, support community education, organize approved activities and contribute professional or community skills.

2.5 Healthcare Professionals

Healthcare professionals can support cancer education, answer technical questions within their scope, guide volunteers and contribute to approved community activities.

2.6 Non-Healthcare Professionals

Non-healthcare volunteers are welcome. AAC will provide simple explanations of the cancer topic and the materials needed for the project. Volunteers should use AAC approved information and should not present themselves as healthcare professionals.

2.7 Digital and Creative Contributors

AAC needs people who can communicate the work. Contributions may include graphic design, video production, photography, writing, social media, web development, data analysis, software development, communications and public relations.

2.8 Campus Ambassadors

Campus Ambassadors serve as AAC representatives within their universities. They may create awareness about AAC, recruit interested students, organize campus activities, connect students to projects, support school/community projects, communicate opportunities and help coordinate volunteers.

SECTION 3: HOW THE AAC COMMUNITY WORKS

AAC has different departments that organize projects and activities. When a department has an approved project, the project will be communicated to volunteers. Interested volunteers indicate their interest and are organized into appropriate teams.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Need identified	Department designs	Project announced	Volunteers indicate	Teams formed	AAC supports	Project conducted	Document • Verify • Portfolio

SIMPLE RULE

Joining a project does not mean every volunteer must perform the same task. A successful team divides responsibilities so that education, coordination, assessment and documentation are covered.

SECTION 4: HOW TO CARRY OUT AN AAC COMMUNITY PROJECT

THE PROJECT MODEL

Prepare → Educate → Assess → Document → Submit

4.1 Choose Your Project

- Cancer education
- Cervical cancer awareness
- Breast cancer awareness
- Prostate cancer education
- Childhood cancer awareness
- HPV vaccination education
- Cancer prevention education
- Early detection education
- Patient support activities
- Cancer advocacy
- Community campaigns

4.2 Identify Your Target Community

- Secondary schools: AAC's preferred setting
- Churches
- Mosques
- Universities and student communities

- Workplaces/community groups where appropriate

4.3 Obtain Permission

- Get permission from the school, church, mosque or relevant community authority before the activity.
- For minors, follow safeguarding and photography/video permission requirements.

4.4 Prepare Your Educational Materials

- Use AAC approved materials.
- Keep the session simple, practical and understandable.
- Non-health volunteers will receive the cancer information they need.

4.5 Conduct the Pre-Assessment

- Give participants a short set of questions before the session.
- Use the assessment supplied or approved by AAC where applicable.

4.6 Deliver the Education Session

- Explain the topic in simple language.
- Allow questions.
- Use myth-and-fact activities or short interactive activities.
- Do not turn the session into a complicated medical lecture.

4.7 Conduct the Post-Assessment

- Give the same or approved equivalent short assessment after the education.
- This helps AAC show whether knowledge improved.

4.8 Document the Activity

- Record date, location, number reached, topic, volunteers, attendance, assessment results, photos, videos, testimonials, feedback and a short project summary.

4.9 Submit Your Project Report

- Submit the required evidence to the relevant AAC department/project coordinator.

4.10 Project Verification

- AAC reviews the submission and verifies the activity before adding it to the volunteer's portfolio.

EXAMPLE OF MEASURABLE IMPACT

300 students participated. Average pre-assessment: 4/10. Average post-assessment: 8/10. AAC can report that the project reached 300 students and demonstrated an improvement in average knowledge scores from 40% to 80%.

SECTION 5: PRIORITY COMMUNITIES

Priority	Setting	How It Is Used
1	Secondary schools	Preferred setting; student groups are encouraged to use school networks.
2	Churches	For volunteers who cannot access a school; 30+ participants recommended where practical.
3	Mosques	May be used where appropriate and with permission.
4	Universities	Useful for student/community education and volunteer activities.
5	Other approved settings	Workplaces, community associations and

		other suitable communities.
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WHY SECONDARY SCHOOLS?

AAC places priority on secondary school students because educating young people creates an opportunity to influence health knowledge early.

SECTION 6: PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

6.1 Student Groups

Students are encouraged to form groups. This makes projects easier to organize, reduces cost and allows volunteers to divide responsibilities.

Group size	Minimum for Certificate of Honor	Simple approach
2–4 students	3 completed projects within six months	Small team; divide education, coordination and documentation.
5–10 students	5 completed projects within six months	Larger team; divide education and documentation/assessment teams.

6.2 Individual Volunteers

An individual volunteer who cannot access a school may conduct an approved project in a church, mosque, community association, workplace, university community or another approved setting. For community education activities, AAC recommends reaching a reasonable audience of at least 30 participants where practical.

6.3 Combining Projects Efficiently

The purpose is not to make volunteers compete. It is to encourage meaningful community engagement. AAC understands that volunteers are students and may have limited money and time. A group can organize multiple project activities efficiently.

EXAMPLE: GROUP OF 10

5 volunteers = Education Team: presentation, questions and interactive activities.

5 volunteers = Documentation & Assessment Team: registration, pre/post assessment, photos/videos, attendance and feedback.

The full group can report: AAC Student Project Team — 10 volunteers — 300 students reached.

6.4 What Counts as a Completed Project

- Participated in an approved AAC activity
- Completed the assigned responsibility
- Reached the intended community
- Documented the activity
- Submitted the required evidence
- Completed pre/post assessment where applicable
- Received verification from the relevant AAC department

The project is then added to the volunteer's AAC portfolio.

SECTION 7: YOUR AAC PORTFOLIO

7.1 What Is the Volunteer Portfolio?

Your portfolio is your record of what you actually contributed. It should show evidence, not just participation.

7.2 What Goes Into Your Portfolio

Portfolio Area	Evidence You Can Build
Community Impact	Projects; people reached; schools/community organizations; cancer topics; pre/post results; photos; videos; testimonials
Leadership	Team leadership; project coordination; community partnerships; volunteer coordination
Professional Skills	Public speaking; health education; project management; graphic design; video; social media; data; writing; research; technology; communication

7.3 Before and After AAC

A volunteer may begin with good academic performance but limited community project experience. After AAC, the portfolio can show verified projects, people reached, cancer education activities, teamwork, project planning, assessment, documentation and an AAC certificate.

7.4 Community Impact Evidence

- Project reports
- Attendance records
- Pre/post assessment results
- Approved photos and videos
- Testimonials and feedback
- Project summaries
- AAC verification

7.5 Digital Skills Portfolio

Skill	Possible Portfolio Evidence
Graphic design	Cancer awareness flyers, social media graphics, campaign materials, infographics
Video	Project videos, awareness videos, interviews, short-form educational content
Photography	Community activities, project documentation, campaign photography
Writing	Cancer awareness articles, project reports, social media content, campaign stories
Social media	Campaign management, content calendars, social posts, engagement reports
Development	Websites, digital tools, data systems, cancer education platforms

7.6 Healthcare Portfolio

Healthcare students and professionals may document cancer education, community engagement, technical support within their scope, health communication, project coordination and other verified contributions.

7.7 Non-Healthcare Portfolio

Non-healthcare volunteers can build evidence in community engagement, communication, leadership, organization, design, media, data, business, technology and other professional skills while contributing to cancer awareness.

SECTION 8: CERTIFICATES & RECOGNITION

Recognition	Who Receives It	Basis
Certificate of Participation	Volunteers who participate but do not complete higher requirements	Verified participation
Certificate of Honor: Continental Cancer Advocate	Eligible volunteers completing required community projects in the six-month cycle	Students: 2–4 = 3 projects; 5–10 = 5 projects. Individuals = minimum 3 verified projects.
Advanced Volunteer Recognition	Outstanding volunteers with substantial	Documented leadership/impact

	contribution	
Digital & Professional Contribution Recognition	Substantial creative/professional contributors	Documented work in design, video, photography, social media, writing, web, data, software, communications/PR
Special Awards	Outstanding contributors	AAC recognition

8.5 Special Awards

- Outstanding Cancer Advocate
- Outstanding Student Volunteer
- Outstanding Community Impact
- Outstanding Team Leader
- Outstanding Digital Contributor
- Outstanding Creative Contributor
- Outstanding Campus Coordinator
- Outstanding Volunteer of the Year

8.6 Becoming a Full AAC Member

Volunteers who complete the required volunteer activities and earn the Certificate of Honor as a Continental Cancer Advocate become full members of the AAC community, subject to AAC membership policies.

- Participate in AAC projects
- Mentor newer volunteers
- Join future programmes
- Apply for leadership opportunities
- Participate in campaigns
- Support community activities
- Become eligible for selected AAC opportunities

SECTION 9: OPPORTUNITIES AFTER AAC

WHAT YOUR PORTFOLIO SHOWS

Leadership + Community Service + Cancer Knowledge + Teamwork + Measurable Impact

Opportunity	What Your Portfolio Can Demonstrate
Jobs	Teamwork, project management, communication, community engagement, data collection, presentations and problem-solving.
Scholarships	Community leadership, service and measurable impact.
Fellowships	Documented leadership and community projects.
Further education	Evidence relevant to public health, pharmacy, medicine, nursing, health education, global health, development, leadership and social innovation.
Leadership	Readiness to coordinate people and activities.
Mentorship	Experienced volunteers may mentor newer members.
References	AAC may provide recommendations/references where a sufficient documented relationship and contribution exists.
AAC Leadership & Cancer Fellowship	Outstanding volunteers may be encouraged to apply for the more selective fellowship.
Alumni network	Continue participating, mentoring, joining campaigns and accessing selected AAC opportunities.

SECTION 10: CODE OF CONDUCT

- Respect community members.
- Respect other volunteers.
- Avoid discrimination.
- Provide accurate information.
- Avoid spreading cancer misinformation.
- Follow AAC-approved educational materials.
- Protect participant privacy.
- Obtain appropriate permission for photographs and videos.
- Never present yourself as a medical professional if you are not one.
- Follow instructions from project coordinators.

REPRESENTING AAC

AAC volunteers represent the organization whenever they participate in an official AAC activity. Professional behaviour, accurate information and respect for communities are required.

SECTION 11: SIMPLE PROJECT CHECKLIST

Before a Project

- Choose approved topic
- Form your team
- Identify community
- Obtain permission
- Contact AAC/project coordinator
- Prepare materials
- Prepare pre/post assessment

During the Project

- Register participants
- Conduct pre-assessment
- Deliver education
- Allow questions
- Conduct post-assessment
- Take approved photographs/videos
- Record attendance

After the Project

- Calculate number reached
- Review assessment results
- Collect feedback
- Prepare project report
- Submit evidence to AAC
- Add project to portfolio

PREPARE	EDUCATE	ASSESS	DOCUMENT	SUBMIT	VERIFY
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

THE SIX-MONTH VOLUNTEER JOURNEY

Month	Focus	What You Do
1	WELCOME & ORIENTATION	Join AAC community; understand the organization; learn your role; receive cancer education materials; join a department/project group.
2	FIRST PROJECT	Select project; identify community; obtain permission; conduct education; document activity.
3	COMMUNITY ACTION	Participate in additional projects; build teamwork skills; continue documenting impact.
4	EXPAND YOUR IMPACT	Participate in more projects; reach additional communities; take on greater responsibility.
5	DOCUMENT YOUR PORTFOLIO	Complete outstanding projects; organize evidence; submit project documentation.
6	RECOGNITION	Final verification; portfolio review; certificates; recognition of outstanding volunteers; transition into full AAC membership where applicable.

SIX-MONTH GOAL

Do not wait until the final month. Start small in Month 1, complete your first project early, keep your evidence organized and build your portfolio as you go.

FINAL MESSAGE

You do not need to wait until you become a doctor, scientist, professor or government official before you begin making an impact.

Start with what you have.

- If you are a student, use your school network.
- If you are a healthcare professional, use your knowledge.
- If you are a business professional, use your organizational skills.
- If you are a designer, use your creativity.
- If you are a developer, use your technology skills.
- If you are a community leader, use your network.
- If you are simply someone who cares about cancer, start by educating one person.

ONE PERSON BECOMES TEN. TEN BECOMES 100. AND 100 BECOMES A COMMUNITY.

Africa Against Cancer is building a community where young Africans do not only talk about the cancer problem, we participate in solving it.

**Welcome to the AAC community.
Learn. Serve. Lead. Impact.**

AFRICA AGAINST CANCER
Building a generation of African cancer advocates and leaders.